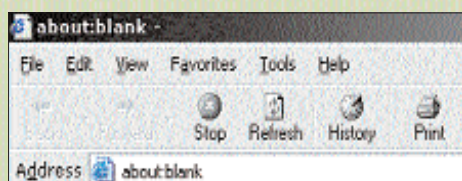


USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced, and select the entry called 'StartMenuScrollPrograms'. If it's not present, create a new String value called 'StartMenuScrollPrograms'. Specify the value as 'Yes' if you want the Start menu to scroll, and 'No' if you need the Start menu as multiple columns.

IE Title bar text

Internet Explorer installations distributed by companies other than Microsoft might have their names in the title bar. If you want to change this, navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Main**, and edit or create a string value entry called 'Window Title'. Double-click the entry and enter any



Remove unwanted text from the IE title bar

string you want. Leave it blank if you want to remove the default string. You'll need to restart Internet Explorer for the change to take effect.

Size of desktop icons

Using the Control Panel display settings, icons in Windows can be displayed in only two different sizes. Tweaking the registry allows you to have any size for icons. Go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop\WindowMetrics**, and create or modify the string value 'Shell Icon Size'. Give the value of your desired icon size, in pixels.

Extracting the product key

The Windows product key is sometimes forgotten or mis-

placed after the Windows installation. This serves as a blockade during the inevitable Windows reinstall. In case of Windows 95, the product key can be obtained from the system properties window (**Windows key + [Pause/Break]**). For Windows 98, it's possible to extract the key from the registry. Select the **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion** key, and in the right pane, the value of the entry **ProductKey** will give the product key of the current Windows installation.

Logon message

To create a personalised logon message in XP, go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\WindowsNT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon**. In the right pane, double-click

the string entry 'LegalNoticeCaption', enter the string 'My Windows XP Machine' and click OK.

Next, double-click the 'LegalNoticeText' string entry, and enter the message to be displayed.

Screensaver grace period

If you've set a screen saver password in Windows 2000 or XP, and the screen saver activates, there is a grace period before which Windows doesn't prompt for a password when you press a key or move the mouse. For security reasons, it is advised that you remove this grace period. Go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\WindowsNT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon**, create a string entry named 'ScreenSaverGracePeriod' and give it a value of '0'. If the key exists, modify its value to '0', or else create a DWORD entry, with the above details.

Display Administrator in logon screen

Like the root user in Linux, Windows XP has a default user called 'Administrator'. This user is not displayed in the logon screen where all the users in the system are displayed. To view this account, go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\WindowsNT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\SpecialAccounts\UserList**. If the binary Administrator key does not exist, create it. Assign its value to '1' to see the Administrator, or '0' to hide it.

Change the welcome screen

Windows XP displays three different screens during boot-up. The second screen is the one that says "Welcome". To change this, navigate to **HKEY_USERS\DEFAULT\Control Panel\Desktop**. Under this key, you will find an entry named 'Wallpaper'; double-click it and enter the path of the image file you want displayed. The file can be a BMP or JPEG image. If you want to tile the image, set the value of the 'TileWallPaper' entry to 1. If you want to stretch the wallpaper, set the value of the 'WallPaperStyle' entry to 2.

Colour of encrypted and compressed files

Windows XP displays encrypted and compressed files and folders in a different colour. To change the default colour, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer**. Create a DWORD value with the name 'NoViewOnDrive'. Double click this entry and in the dialog box that appears, select the radio button named 'Decimal'. In the value data field you need to enter a number that depends on the drive that needs to be hidden. Use the formula '2ⁿ⁻¹', where n is 1 for your A drive, 2 for B

pressed files and folders, create or modify a binary entry named 'AltColor'. Specify its value as mentioned above. For this tweak to work, the 'Show encrypted and compressed folders in color' must be enabled via the folder options window.

Detailed information in the device manager

When this tweak is applied, the device manager in Windows 2000 and XP will show an extra tab called 'Details'. Selecting this tab will provide additional information about the device. Go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\SessionManager\Environment**. Here, you'll find a string entry with the name 'DEVMGR_SHOW_DETAILS'; if there isn't one, create it. Assign this entry a value of '1' if you want the system to display the details tab; to hide the tab, assign it a value of '0'.

Prevent access to specified drives

Use this tweak to prevent access to drives to certain users. Remember, once this is applied, the prohibited user can't access the drive by any means. Log into Windows using the user account that you want to restrict access to, open the registry editor and go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer**. Create a DWORD value with the name 'NoViewOnDrive'. Double click this entry and in the dialog box that appears, select the radio button named 'Decimal'. In the value data field you need to enter a number that depends on the drive that needs to be hidden. Use the formula '2ⁿ⁻¹', where n is 1 for your A drive, 2 for B